Ronan O’Leary (Rónán Ó Laoire)

TECHNOLOGY & PRODUCT LEADER | FORMER CTO | HANDS-ON ENGINEERING

+31 6 180 66136 · roleary81@gmail.com · Amsterdam, Netherlands

ronan-oleary.com · cogar.ie · linkedin.com/in/ronanoleary · github.com/RoOLeary

PROFILE

Technology and product leader with 16+ years of experience spanning software engineering, platform architecture, engineering management and digital product delivery. Former CTO at The Next Web, where I led a nine-person engineering team and worked directly with executive leadership on technical strategy, modernisation and product priorities. More recently founded and built Cogar, a consumer social platform launched on iOS and Android and grown to an audience of more than 5,000 registered users. Comfortable moving between strategic planning, team leadership and hands-on development, with a pragmatic approach to building maintainable products and capable teams.

LEADERSHIP & PRODUCT STRENGTHS

Technology strategy & roadmaps · Product ownership & delivery · Engineering leadership & mentoring · Recruitment & team development · Architecture & platform modernisation · Cross-functional stakeholder management · Consumer mobile & web products · Technical debt & operational reliability · AI-assisted engineering workflows

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

Founder & Developer | Cogar Teicneolaíochta Ltd

May 2025 – Present · Ireland

Founder-led Irish-language social and community platform. Launched May 2026; available on iOS and Android.

- Own product direction and delivery end to end: discovery, prioritisation, architecture, implementation, launch, operations and continuous improvement.
- Built a full-featured consumer mobile product incorporating social feeds, messaging, profiles, notifications, community features, moderation and advertising capabilities.
- Grew the registered audience beyond 5,000; use product analytics and community feedback to guide iteration and engagement improvements.
- Develop commercial planning around advertising, partnerships and sustainable platform growth, alongside hands-on engineering and infrastructure management.
- Technical environment: React Native, Expo, TypeScript, Supabase/PostgreSQL, cloud services and integrations; AI-assisted development practices.

Chief Technology Officer / Engineering Manager / Senior Developer | The Next Web

November 2017 – October 2022 · Amsterdam

- Progressed into CTO responsibility, reporting to the CEO and working with senior leadership on engineering strategy, product roadmaps and technical priorities across business verticals.
- Led and mentored a nine-person engineering team covering frontend, backend and data, with responsibility for delivery, team development and engineering practices.
- Led a major platform modernisation: consolidating approximately 14 installations into a shared headless, multisite publishing platform and integrating formerly separate systems.
- Worked on internal products including the Earlybird ticketing platform; helped evolve digital products and operations during the shift to online events.

Tech Lead, Web Team | Picnic Technologies BV

November 2022 – March 2024 · Amsterdam

- Led web engineering delivery and contributed to long-term digital roadmaps, system architecture, planning, incident response and operational reporting.
- Coached engineers working on bespoke web platforms and modern frontend systems, bridging product needs and implementation decisions.

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Contract Senior Web Developer | Findest

November 2024 – March 2026

- Worked on an in-house AI-powered search tool, including client-facing white-label implementations and application development.

Founder / Independent Software Engineer | Busy Little Pixels

April 2025 – Present · Netherlands

- Provide independent software engineering and technical consultancy across web applications, mobile products, APIs and integrations.

Fractional CTO / Tech Lead / Senior Developer | Independent Contracting

March 2024 – November 2024

- Advised and delivered for organisations across events, recruitment and marketing technology, including team structure, technical architecture and modern web platforms.

Head of Web Development | Trigger Media

August 2016 – November 2017 · Dublin

- Established and led the web development function; delivered client platforms, technical workflows, pitches and cross-functional web initiatives.

Senior Web Developer / Web Team Lead | Web Summit

February 2014 – July 2016 · Dublin

- Led a four-person web team and developed the shared “Flexo” website framework; drove multisite consolidation and early headless-platform direction.

TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

JavaScript & TypeScript · React & React Native · Expo · Next.js · Node.js · PHP & Laravel · PostgreSQL & Supabase · REST & GraphQL · Cloudflare & Hetzner · CI/CD & Git · CMS platforms & headless architecture · AI/LLM integrations

EDUCATION

Higher Diploma, Web Design & Development | Dublin Business School | 2008–2010

Higher Diploma, Public Relations | Irish Academy of Public Relations | 2002–2004

REFERENCES

Available on request.